

Nicholas Mac Gregor Garcia

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English (native) · Mandarin (proficient) · Portuguese (intermediate)

AI governance researcher and educator at the National University of Singapore. I teach Smart Systems and AI Governance, research how large language models and AI agents can be evaluated and held accountable in regulated settings, and organise multi-stakeholder policy programmes with Google, Asia-Pacific universities, and Singapore's financial-technology ecosystem. I write for policy and executive readers on AI accountability and disclosure. PhD in Information Systems, New York University (Stern).

EXPERIENCE

Lecturer (Educator Track), Department of Information Systems and Analytics, School of Computing, National University of Singapore Nov 2022 – present

- Teach IS4246 Smart Systems and AI Governance, IS4228 Information Technologies in Financial Services, and IS4302 Blockchain and Distributed Ledger Technologies.
- Built course material on privacy, responsible AI and model risk, mapped to Singapore's PDPA, the MAS FEAT principles, the OECD AI Principles and the EU AI Act.
- Lead research on AI governance, LLM evaluation for regulatory use, and decentralised systems, with collaborators including MAS, Google.org, PwC and Data.org.
- Supervised and mentored 30+ students; placements include MAS, Visa, KPMG and Coinbase. Average student evaluation 4.8 / 5.

Deputy Director; Co-Director (Industry), NUS FinTech Lab Nov 2022 – present

- Lead the lab's external engagement and partnerships with industry and public-sector stakeholders, including Ripple, Coinbase and Mastercard.
- Helped secure and renew over SGD 1 million in funding from partners including Google.org, Ripple and Data.org.
- Organised the NUS FinTech Lab Crawl (2023, 2024), an ecosystem event with 500+ attendees; gave the opening remarks and partner briefings.
- Delivered executive briefings on AI evaluation and governance to corporate partners and public-sector agencies.

Lead Academic Organiser, Judge and Advisor, APRU Asia-Pacific Tech Policy Hackathon 2024 – 2025

- Co-directed a flagship multi-country programme that brought Google and Asia-Pacific universities together to develop AI governance and data-policy proposals.
- Ran mentor and judge onboarding, evaluation design and end-to-end operations; coached multi-university teams on AI governance, digital inclusion and financial innovation.

Facilitator, Introduction to AI Safety, AIS Collab / ENAIS 2025

- Facilitated a global cohort through a peer-led AI safety course built on syllabi by researchers at Harvard, Oxford, Cambridge and OpenAI; led weekly sessions on AI governance and alignment.

Consultant and Advisor, AI, Data and Technology Policy, startups, industry consortia and multilateral networks (Asia-Pacific) 2024 – present

- Advise on AI and blockchain strategy, regulatory context, positioning and partnerships; facilitate senior sessions on AI risk management.

Earlier teaching: Co-Instructor, Data Analytics for Business, New York University (2020); Instructor, AI ethics and machine learning workshops, Inspirit AI (2021)

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

- Tham, L., Garcia, N. M. G., & Hahn, J. (2026). Internal APIs are all you need: Shadow APIs, shared discovery, and the case against browser-first agent architectures. *arXiv:2604.00694*.
- See, K., Garcia, N., & Li, X. (2025). Simulating blockchain applications in large-value payment systems through agent-based modeling. *AAMAS 2025*.
- Garcia, N., See, K., & Shobri, H. (2024). PSSimPy: A design science approach to constructing and implementing a large-value payment system simulator. *ICIS 2024*.
- Garcia, N. "Rule of code" or "rule of man"? How assumptions of human nature impact the design of blockchain-based algorithmic management systems. Doctoral dissertation, New York University.
- Working paper: Chow, A., & Garcia, N. FairEval: Evaluating LLMs in financial regulation. Target: *MIS Quarterly*.

- Policy research: AI for ASEAN Development, FCDO-funded research on AI governance in climate, education and health policy.

SELECTED POLICY WRITING

Essays for policy and executive readers at nicholasg3.github.io, including:

- Who Is Accountable When AI Acts · When AI Disclosure Is Due · What an AI Disclosure Record Must Contain
- What Agents Are Allowed To Do · AI-Written Research Needs Verification Records More Than a Separate Venue

TALKS AND CONVENINGS

- Speaker, Ethereum Research Forum, ArtScience Museum, Singapore (Sept 2025): blockchain governance and financial systems.
- Panellist and moderator, UNICON 2023, NUS Entrepreneurship Society (600+ participants from 20+ countries).
- Ripple UBRI Connect 2024 (cross-domain risk in arbitrage); DiO Conference 2023 (algorithmic governance); Academy of Management 2020 (ideology in algorithmic governance).

EDUCATION

PhD, Information Systems , New York University, Stern School of Business	2022
Master of Information Systems Management , Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College	2015
BS, Chemical Engineering , University of California, Berkeley	2012

SERVICE AND SKILLS

- Reviewer, International Conference on Information Systems (2018 – present); member, Academy of Management.
- Institutional liaison, APRU–NUS FinTech collaboration; academic advisor, NUS Digital Transformation Leadership Programme (2026).
- LLM benchmarking, explainable AI, multi-agent simulation; Python.